

WINDOWS SHORTCUT KEYS

Complete Reference Guide — 100 Essential Shortcuts

PRODUCTIVITY · EFFICIENCY · SPEED

100

Shortcuts

6

Categories

0

Duplicates

General & System

Windows Key Shortcuts

Window Management

File Explorer

Text Editing

Browser & Task Manager

Ctrl

Alt

Win

Tab

Shift

Esc

F1

F5

Del

PrtSc

Master your keyboard · Work smarter, not harder

Tip

Practise 3 shortcuts/day to build muscle memory fast.

Fact

Power users save 60+ minutes weekly using shortcuts.

Goal

Learn these 100 to cover 95% of all daily tasks.

How to use this guide

1. Each category has its own colour-coded page for quick navigation.
2. Shortcut keys are displayed as keyboard badges — just like real keys.
3. The final page is a full summary of all 100 shortcuts at a glance.

Common Modifier Keys at a Glance

Ctrl

Triggers system commands

Alt

Activates menu options

Win

OS-level shortcuts

Shift

Extends or reverses actions

Esc

Cancel or close dialogs

Tab

Cycle focus between elements

F1-F12

Application-specific functions

Del

Remove selected items

PrtSc

Capture a screenshot

Insert

Toggle insert / overwrite mode

1

Ctrl + C

Copy selected item

2

Ctrl + X

Cut selected item

3

Ctrl + V

Paste copied item

4

Ctrl + Z

Undo last action

5

Ctrl + Y

Redo last action

6

Ctrl + A

Select all items

7

Ctrl + S

Save current file

8

Ctrl + P

Print document

9

Ctrl + N

Open new window or docu...

10

Ctrl + O

Open file dialog

11

Ctrl + W

Close current tab or window

12

Ctrl + F

Find / Search in page

13

Ctrl + H

Find and Replace

14

Ctrl + D

Delete or Bookmark page

15

Alt + F4

Close active window

16

F2

Rename selected file

17

F5

Refresh page or explorer

18

Delete

Send item to Recycle Bin

19

Shift + Delete

Permanently delete item

1

Win

Open or close Start menu

2

Win + D

Show or hide the Desktop

3

Win + E

Open File Explorer

4

Win + L

Lock your PC

5

Win + I

Open Windows Settings

6

Win + R

Open Run dialog box

7

Win + S

Open Windows Search

8

Win + T

Cycle through taskbar apps

9

Win + X

Open Quick Link menu

10

Win + V

Open Clipboard history

11

Win + Tab

Open Task View

12

Win + Pause

Open System Properties

13

Win + Plus

Zoom in using Magnifier

14

Win + Minus

Zoom out using Magnifier

15

Win + PrtSc

Save screenshot to Pictures

16

Win + Shift + S

Snip a screen region

17

Win + Ctrl + D

Create new virtual desktop

18

Win + Ctrl + F4

Close current virtual desktop

19

Win + A

Open Action Center

1

Win + Left Arrow

Snap window to left half

8

Alt + Tab

Switch between open appli...

2

Win + Right Arrow

Snap window to right half

9

Alt + Esc

Cycle windows in open order

3

Win + Up Arrow

Maximize current window

10

Alt + Space

Open window context menu

4

Win + Down Arrow

Minimize or restore window

11

Alt + Enter

Open Properties of selecte...

5

Win + M

Minimize all open windows

12

F11

Toggle full-screen mode

6

Win + Shift + M

Restore all minimized win...

13

Win + Shift + Left

Move window to left monitor

7

Win + Home

Minimize all except active ...

14

Win + Shift + Right

Move window to right mon...

1

Alt + D

Focus the address bar

7

Ctrl + L

Focus address bar

2

Alt + Enter

Open file or folder Properties

8

Ctrl + Shift + N

Create a new folder

3

Alt + Left Arrow

Navigate back in folder his...

9

Ctrl + Mouse Scroll

Change folder icon view size

4

Alt + Right Arrow

Navigate forward in folder ...

10

F4

Display address bar dropd...

5

Alt + Up Arrow

Navigate to parent folder

11

F6

Cycle focus through panes

6

Ctrl + E

Focus the search box

12

Backspace

Go back to previous folder

1

Ctrl + B

Bold selected text

8

Ctrl + Shift + Right

Select one word to the right

2

Ctrl + I

Italicise selected text

9

Ctrl + Shift + Left

Select one word to the left

3

Ctrl + U

Underline selected text

10

Shift + Home

Select from cursor to line s...

4

Ctrl + Home

Move cursor to document ...

11

Shift + End

Select from cursor to line...

5

Ctrl + End

Move cursor to document...

12

Ctrl + Shift + Home

Select from cursor to doc s...

6

Ctrl + Right Arrow

Move cursor one word to t...

13

Ctrl + Shift + End

Select from cursor to doc...

7

Ctrl + Left Arrow

Move cursor one word to t...

14

Insert

Toggle overtype / insert ...

1

Ctrl + T

Open a new browser tab

7

Ctrl + Plus

Zoom in on the browser ...

2

Ctrl + Shift + T

Reopen the last closed tab

8

Ctrl + Minus

Zoom out on the browser ...

3

Ctrl + R

Reload / refresh current ...

9

Ctrl + 0

Reset browser zoom to ...

4

Ctrl + Tab

Switch to next browser tab

10

Ctrl + Shift + I

Open Developer Tools panel

5

Ctrl + Shift + Tab

Switch to previous browser...

11

Ctrl + Alt + Del

Open Windows Security sc...

6

Ctrl + L

Focus the browser address...

12

Ctrl + Shift + Esc

Open Task Manager directly

Quick Reference Summary

All 100 shortcuts at a glance — colour-coded by category

Top 10 Must-Know Shortcuts

1	Ctrl + C / X / V	Copy, Cut, and Paste
2	Ctrl + Z / Y	Undo and Redo
3	Win + D	Show / hide Desktop instantly
4	Alt + F4	Close the active window
5	Win + L	Lock your PC immediately
6	Ctrl+Shift+Esc	Open Task Manager directly
7	Win + Shift + S	Take a screenshot of any region
8	Win + E	Open File Explorer
9	Win + Tab	Open Task View
10	Ctrl + A	Select everything at once

Category Overview

GS General & System 19 shortcuts covered	WK Windows Key Shortcuts 19 shortcuts covered
WM Window Management 14 shortcuts covered	FE File Explorer 12 shortcuts covered
TE Text Editing 14 shortcuts covered	BT Browser & Task Manager 12 shortcuts covered

Pro Tips for Learning Shortcuts

- Learn by context — memorise shortcuts for the app you use most first.
- Stick a printed cheat sheet on your monitor for the first two weeks.
- Pair each shortcut with a spoken cue (e.g. 'Ctrl+Z = undo') for recall.